



INTERIOR DESIGN & BUILD · MIAMI

2026 EDITION · FREE GUIDE

The Miami Renovation & Interior Cost Guide

Real 2026 price ranges, the condo rules nobody warns you about, how to budget without surprises, and how to tell a great contractor from an expensive mistake — from a design-build team working in Miami every day.

Renovating in Miami shouldn't be a guessing game

Most people start a renovation with two questions — **what will it cost** and **who can I trust** — and get vague answers to both. We built this guide to fix that. Everything inside reflects how good work is actually priced and delivered in Miami-Dade in 2026: honest ranges, the building rules that trip people up, and the questions that separate a real studio from a cheap quote you'll pay for twice.

No email funnels or fine print here — just the information we'd want if it were our home. If it saves you one costly mistake, it did its job.

INSIDE THIS GUIDE

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ 01 What a renovation really costs in Miami | ☐ 04 How to budget so there are no surprises |
| ☐ 02 What drives your price up (and down) | ☐ 05 Choosing a contractor: red vs green flags |
| ☐ 03 The condo reality: boards, COI & permits | ☐ 06 Timeline & your pre-renovation checklist |

Want your own number in 60 seconds? The instant estimate at m5miami.com gives you a live range for your exact project — then we confirm it with a free on-site visit and an itemized quote within 48 hours.

What a renovation really costs

Ranges below reflect quality design-build work in Miami-Dade — materials, labor and management included. A cheap crew quotes less and costs more by the end. Every M5 quote is itemized line by line before you sign, and it doesn't move without a change order you approve first.

Scope of work	Typical 2026 range
Interior design + photoreal 3D	from \$6 / sq ft
Turnkey apartment renovation	from \$145 / sq ft
Kitchen remodel	\$40K – \$90K+
Bathroom remodel	\$25K – \$60K+
Decorative plaster (Venetian · microcement)	from \$18 / sq ft · projects from \$10K
New construction / villa	from \$390 / sq ft

FINISH LEVEL CHANGES EVERYTHING

The same square footage can swing 70% on finish level alone. Here's the multiplier we use on a turnkey renovation:

×1.0

Standard

Quality materials, clean detailing, durable everyday finishes.

×1.35

Premium

Custom joinery, stone, designer lighting and higher-end fixtures.

×1.7

Luxury

Signature materials, full custom millwork, imported finishes.

Worked example. A 1,200 sq ft apartment, turnkey, at Premium level: roughly **\$210K – \$270K**. A 345 sq ft kitchen at Premium: around **\$55K – \$75K**. Your instant estimate on the site does this math live.

Five things that decide your budget

Driver	Impact
Scope & layout changes	Moving walls, plumbing or electrical adds cost fast
Finish level	Standard → Luxury can nearly double the same space
Custom joinery & stone	Bespoke millwork and slab selection are big line items
Building rules	Condo requirements, permits and access add time & cost
Condition of the space	Older units hide surprises behind the walls — a buffer matters

WHERE SMART MONEY GOES — AND WHERE IT DOESN'T

Worth it

Layout and light (you feel it daily), waterproofing and what's behind the walls, kitchen and primary bath, and the surfaces you touch — floors, doors, hardware, plaster.

Easy to over-spend

Trend-driven finishes you'll tire of, oversized appliances, and "feature" materials in low-traffic rooms. We'll tell you where a dollar shows and where it disappears.

Our rule: spend where you live. We steer budget toward the moments you use every day and protect the parts you can't see — so the result feels expensive without wasting money.

What renovating in a condo really involves

This is where most Miami renovations lose weeks and money. Handled well, none of it touches you — it's simply part of the process.

Requirement		What it means for you
Condo board approval	Plans, insurance and licenses reviewed before work starts — allow 2–6 weeks.	We prepare the full package.
Certificate of Insurance	Your building demands a COI from every contractor. No COI, no elevator access, no work.	
Elevator & loading	Materials move only through booked service elevators in set hours — bad logistics costs weeks.	
Noise hours	Demolition is often limited to 9–5 weekdays; the schedule is built around it.	
Miami-Dade permits	Electrical, plumbing and structural work needs permits. Unpermitted work can block your future sale.	

M5 handles all of it — board package, COI, elevator bookings, permits and inspections — as part of every project. You approve; we run the paperwork.

Buying to renovate or flip? Bring us in before you close. A 20-minute walkthrough can flag the difference between a \$60K refresh and a \$200K rebuild — and change what you're willing to pay.

How to budget so there are no surprises

- Set your range, then add a **10–15% buffer** — older Miami units hide surprises behind the walls.
- Insist on an **itemized estimate** before signing — never one lump number.
- Pay by **milestones tied to progress** — never a large deposit upfront.
- Put **change-order rules** in the contract: nothing changes the price without your written approval.
- Ask for **weekly photo updates** and a **written warranty** in the contract.

Red flags vs green flags

Walk away if...

- ✗ The quote is one line and price "depends"
- ✗ They want a big cash deposit upfront
- ✗ They say "we don't need permits"
- ✗ No portfolio, no names, no warranty
- ✗ You can't reach one accountable person

Good sign if...

- ✓ Itemized estimate before any contract
- ✓ Milestone payments tied to progress
- ✓ Permits & COI handled for you
- ✓ Named team, real projects, warranty in writing
- ✓ One point of contact, start to finish

A clear timeline, start to finish

01	Consultation & needs	≈ 1 WEEK
We meet at your space, discuss goals and budget, agree what success looks like — before any contract.		
02	Concept	≈ 1–2 WEEKS
A few conceptual directions to lock the style, layout logic and budget frame.		
03	Design & 3D	≈ 2–3 WEEKS
Layouts, photoreal 3D, materials and an itemized budget — you sign knowing exactly what you get.		
04	Build & fit-out	PER ESTIMATE
Permitted, insured construction with weekly photo updates and milestone payments.		
05	Handover & warranty	FINAL WEEK
Final cleaning, walkthrough and a 2-year written warranty backed by the same team that built it.		

A typical apartment renovation runs up to 3 months. You get the timeline upfront and know where things stand the whole way.

YOUR PRE-RENOVATION CHECKLIST

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ Define budget range + 10–15% buffer | ☐ Demand an itemized quote — not one number |
| ☐ Collect 10–15 reference photos you love | ☐ Agree milestone payments & change-order rules |
| ☐ Check your building's renovation rules early | ☐ Confirm who manages permits & the board |
| ☐ Ask every contractor for license & insurance | ☐ Get the warranty in writing |



WHY M5

One team. One contract. One point of responsibility.

Behind M5 is one in-house team — designers, project managers and our own site crews — not a chain of anonymous subcontractors. We put our names and faces to every project, handle the board, permits and COI, and back the work with a 2-year written warranty. Design, build and decorative plaster, from first sketch to final handover.

48h

ITEMIZED QUOTE

2yr

WRITTEN WARRANTY

100%

INSURED · PERMITTED

Ready for your real number?

Get a live instant estimate, book a free on-site visit, or just message us — no pressure, no obligation.

M5MIAMI.COM · HELLO@M5MIAMI.COM

WHATSAPP +971 58 581 4215